

CLA Brand & Design Language OS v1

Working Draft (Refreshed)

Approved sections are frozen unless the project owner requests changes.

Section 1 — Brand Personality (APPROVED)

Core Personality

Elegant • Minimal • Vibrant

Elegant through craftsmanship and restraint. Minimal through clarity, simplicity, and intentional spacing. Vibrant through carefully chosen color, photography, and moments of energy—not clutter.

Section 2 — Visual Direction (APPROVED)

Primary Direction

Apple-level product quality combined with a modern premium church aesthetic.

Principles

Premium craftsmanship, timeless design, welcoming, professional execution, and every page should point people back to Jesus through clarity rather than distraction.

Section 3 — Official Color System (APPROVED)

Primary: Royal Blue

Dark Foundation: Dark Navy

Backgrounds: White + Warm Off-White / Ivory

Gold: Secondary accent used sparingly.

Orange: Supporting accent used globally and more prominently for Kids, Events, and Seasonal pages.

Gradients are allowed when elegant and purposeful.

Each ministry may have its own accent color while remaining unmistakably CLA.

Section 4 — Typography (APPROVED)

Apple-inspired modern + elegant editorial typography.

Two font families by default; third only for special campaigns.

Bold, commanding headings.

Neutral, highly readable body text.

Very strong hierarchy.

Mixed alignment.

Apple-style rounded buttons.

Generous white space.

Moderate motion.

Mostly solid typography colors.

Section 5 — Photography (APPROVED)

Authentic real moments; never staged or stock-like.

Tone matches the story.

Balanced immersive and contained layouts.

Balanced portraits and environmental storytelling.

Preserve natural image orientation; never force portrait images into landscape crops.

Balanced natural/cinematic editing.

One strong image per section by default.

Minimal decorative effects.

Editorial overlap only when it improves composition.

One consistent CLA photography style with limited page-specific adaptation.

Every major page begins with a signature hero photograph.

Next Section

Section 6 — Layout & White Space (Not yet completed)